



SOFTWARE ENGINEER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Software engineers plan, analyze, design, develop, test, and carry out maintenance work on a wide variety of computer software products. These can range from games, apps, and home entertainment systems, to programs that run a computer's operating system or control network communications between computers.



SALARY

Junior engineer ★★☆☆☆

Senior engineer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

High demand • Many jobs in software and telecommunication companies • Highly paid contract-based roles available for experienced engineers

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Computer science • Information Technology (IT) • Mathematics • Physics • Engineering • New technologies



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree or a postgraduate qualification in software engineering or a related discipline is the best way to get a job.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are flexible, but tight deadlines demand long hours. Work is usually office-based; travel to meet clients is possible.



LOCATION Although this job is typically office-based, it is common for software engineers to do some work from home.



THE REALITIES The market is highly competitive. Junior software engineers can spend a lot of time tracking down bugs rather than writing their own code.

CAREER PATHS

Software engineers start their careers supporting a team that is developing or modifying computer code. After gaining experience and knowledge of multiple computer systems and languages, they can progress to lead their own development teams or enter specialized areas of the industry.

GRADUATE You will need a degree in an analytical or technical subject—but not necessarily in computer science or Information Technology (IT)—and some experience in computer coding.



POSTGRADUATE If you hold a degree in a nontechnical discipline, you may take an IT conversion course at postgraduate level. It is increasingly popular to learn to write software through online and independent study.

